

HISTORY HACK · DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

Document-Based Question

US.11 — Compare and contrast the concepts of social Darwinism and the Social Gospel.

US.13 — Describe working conditions in industries during this era, including the use of women and children as a labor source.

US.14 — Explain the rise of the labor movement, union tactics (e.g., strikes), the role of leaders (e.g., Eugene Debs and Samuel Gompers), and the responses of management and government.

TEACHER EDITION — scoring guide and expected evidence. Not for student distribution.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

The sources

Document 1

Samuel Gompers, Testimony before the U.S. Senate Committee on Education and Labor, 1883.
United States Senate Historical Records; also available through the Library of Congress.

“We do not want any class legislation. What we want is fair play, and we do not want interference, either from the government on the one hand or from monopoly on the other. We simply ask that the working people shall have a chance — a fair field and no favor... We are not asking for charity. We are asking for our rights, as men. If men who wish to sell the labor of their hands are free to combine for the purpose of getting the best price for that labor, then capital also has a right to combine. The question is whether, in practice, combination by capital can be made as effective and as free from reprisal as combination by labor.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 1

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

Document 2

New York Factory Investigating Commission, Preliminary Report, Volume I, 1912. Available through the New York State Library and the National Archives.

“This Commission finds that the present labor law of the State of New York is inadequate to protect those employed in manufacturing establishments... The Commission recommends the enactment of legislation providing: (1) that all factory buildings shall be fireproof in construction; (2) that all exits, stairways, and fire escapes shall be adequate in number and construction; (3) that a working day of not more than 54 hours per week shall be established for women and minors; (4) that labor inspectors shall have authority to close unsafe premises without judicial approval.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 2

H — Historical context

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Document 3

Clayton Antitrust Act, Section 6, United States Congress, October 15, 1914. National Archives and Records Administration.

“The labor of a human being is not a commodity or article of commerce. Nothing contained in the antitrust laws shall be construed to forbid the existence and operation of labor, agricultural, or horticultural organizations, instituted for the purposes of mutual help, and not having capital stock or conducted for profit, or to forbid or restrain individual members of such organizations from lawfully carrying out the legitimate objects thereof; nor shall such organizations, or the members thereof, be held or construed to be illegal combinations or conspiracies in restraint of trade, under the antitrust laws.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 3

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

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Who is speaking, and how
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The question

Apply HIPP to each document, construct a clear argument, use all three documents as evidence, and incorporate at least two outside historical facts.

Plan your answer

Your claim	
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Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document 1		
Document 2		
Document 3		
Outside knowledge		

Write your response

Scoring guide

Pts	6-point scale
6	Exemplary. Constructs a sophisticated argument about the extent of Progressive labor reform using all three documents as evidence. Applies HIPP to each document with specific attention to purpose and point of view as tools for evaluating the limits of each document's perspective on reform. Incorporates two or more outside historical facts. Cross-document synthesis: e.g., connecting Gompers's 1883 framework to the Clayton Act's 1914 declaration, or tracing the gap between the Factory Commission's recommendations and their actual enforcement record. Evaluates both what was achieved and what remained unchanged.
5	Advanced. Strong argument with HIPP of all three documents. Two outside facts. Cross-document synthesis present. Achievement vs. limitation both addressed.
4	Proficient. Clear argument with HIPP of two documents. One outside fact. Structural achievement vs. minimal concession distinction addressed but not fully evaluated.
3	Adequate. Takes a position but relies mainly on describing the documents. HIPP of one document. One outside fact.
2	Developing. Summarizes documents without analytical argument. Limited HIPP.
1	Beginning. Lists document information without argument.
0	No response or off-topic.

Expected evidence and document analysis. KEY EVIDENCE EXPECTED: Pullman Strike (1894) and government use of Sherman Act injunction against Debs/ARU; AFL membership growth from 140,000 (1886) to 1.5M (1904) to 4M (1920); Triangle Shirtwaist fire (1911) and NY Factory Acts (1911-1913); Clayton Act (1914) and its subsequent interpretation by courts in Duplex Printing Press Co. v. Deering (1921); the absence of a federal minimum wage until the Fair Labor Standards Act (1938); the exclusion of agricultural and domestic workers from most Progressive labor protections; women's hours legislation upheld in Muller v. Oregon (1908) — paternalistic progress.

Sourcing. Every document above carries its own citation as written in the item record. Verify each against the holding institution before classroom use — an unsourced primary source is worse than a missing one.

History Hack · TroopToTeacher Technologies. Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28. classroom-formative · pre-field-test — this activity has not been field-tested and its scoring guide is not calibrated.